

Wise Leader

A **caravan** consisting of 500 bullock carts and led by an old and experienced **merchant** was on its way to a **distant** land. One day when the caravan **halted** on the **outskirts** of a village for the midday meal, some of the men noticed a tree **laden with** ripe fruits that looked like mangoes.

They started **knocking down** the fruits when one of the men, more **cautious** than the others, informed the leader about what was happening. The old merchant **rushed** to the spot.

"Don't eat those fruits," he **shouted**. "They are poisonous!"

The men immediately **threw away** the fruits they had collected. The merchant-leader then gave orders for the caravan to **resume** its journey.

"But before we go, let's destroy the tree," he said. "It's a death trap for travellers."

As the tree fell, people from the nearby village came rushing to the spot.

"What have you done?!" they **moaned**.

"You've destroyed our **livelihood**!" Whenever a traveller died after eating a fruit, we would divide his **possessions** among us. Now what shall we do?"

"Find an honest way of making a living," advised the merchant.

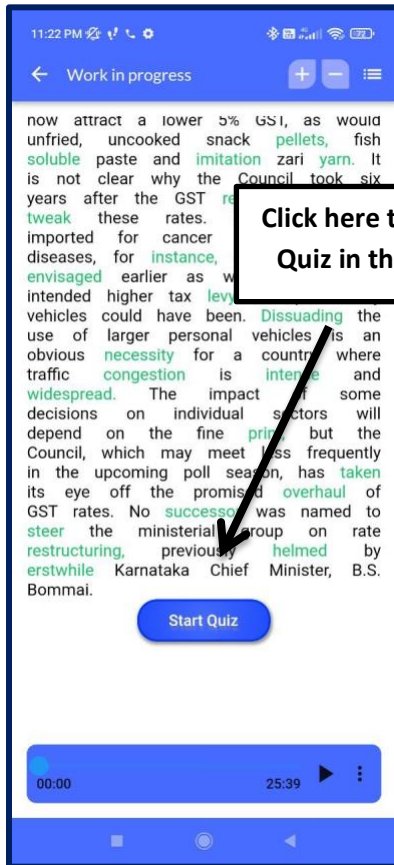
"How did you know the fruits were poisonous?" asked the villagers. "This tree has been here for years. No traveller could ever **resist** eating a fruit." "I was guided by common sense, explained the leader. "If **luscious** mango-like fruits are left untouched it can only mean that they're poisonous."



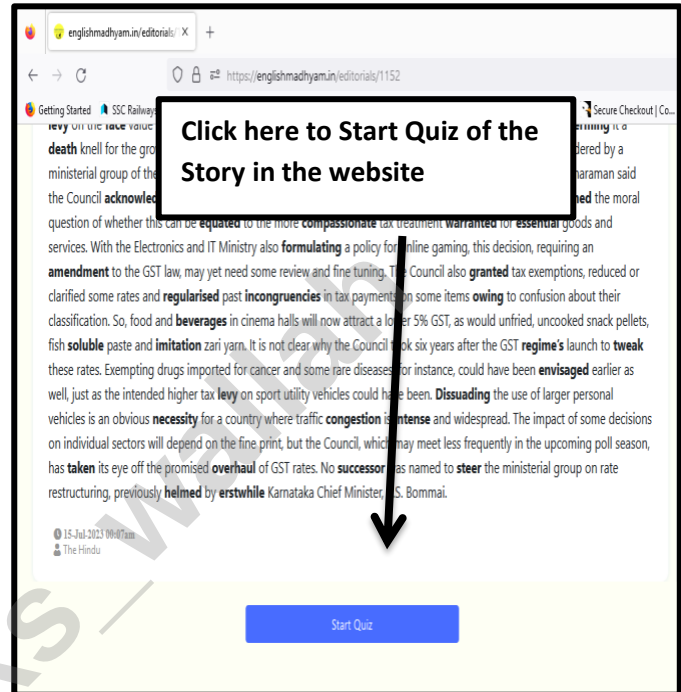
Vocabulary

1. **Wise** (adjective) – Intelligent, sensible, prudent, judicious, sagacious समझदार
2. **Caravan** (noun) – Convoy, procession, expedition, train, group कारवां
3. **Merchant** (noun) – Trader, dealer, seller, businessman, vendor व्यापारी
4. **Distant** (adjective) – Far, remote, faraway, removed, far-off दूरस्थ
5. **Halt** (verb) – Stop, pause, cease, discontinue, standstill रुकना
6. **Outskirt** (noun) – Edge, periphery, fringe, boundary, suburb बाहरी क्षेत्र
7. **Laden** (with) (verb) – Loaded, filled, burdened, piled, charged भरा हुआ
8. **Knock down** (phrasal verb) – Bring down, fell, topple, demolish, strike गिराना
9. **Cautious** (adjective) – Careful, wary, alert, vigilant, prudent सतर्क
10. **Rush** (verb) – Hurry, race, dash, hasten, bolt दौड़ना
11. **Shout** (verb) – Yell, scream, cry, call out, holler चिल्लाना
12. **Throw away** (phrasal verb) – Discard, dispose of, get rid of, toss, dump फेंक देना
13. **Resume** (verb) – Restart, continue, recommence, pick up, proceed फिर से शुरू करना
14. **Moan** (verb) – Groan, lament, wail, complain, grumble कराहना
15. **Livelihood** (noun) – Income, living, means of support, sustenance, occupation आजीविका
16. **Possession** (noun) – Belonging, property, asset, holding, ownership संपत्ति
17. **Resist** (verb) – Withstand, oppose, refuse, fight, defy विरोध करना
18. **Luscious** (adjective) – Juicy, delicious, succulent, mouth-watering, स्वादिष्ट

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